Prodigy Anesthesia Quick Review

Cervical Plexus Block

What muscles are innervated by the cervical plexus?	The muscles of the neck. *Longnecker DE, Newman MF, Brown DL, Zapol WM. Anesthesiology. 2nd ed. New York: McGraw-Hill; 2012: 828.*
From what spinal nerves is the cervical plexus derived?	C2, C3, and C4 *Longnecker DE, Newman MF, Brown DL, Zapol WM. Anesthesiology. 2nd ed. New York: McGraw-Hill; 2012: 828.*
For what procedures are a cervical plexus block useful?	It is excellent for carotid endarterectomy and supplementation of the shoulder if needed following an interscalene block. *Longnecker DE, Newman MF, Brown DL, Zapol WM. Anesthesiology. 2nd ed. New York: McGraw-Hill; 2012: 828.*
What is anesthetized by a superficial cervical plexus block?	The skin of the neck, posterior shoulder, and superior shoulder. The cervical plexus block is unique in that the sensory fibers (superficial cervical plexus block) can be blocked separately from the motor fibers (deep cervical plexus block). *Longnecker DE, Newman MF, Brown DL, Zapol WM. Anesthesiology. 2nd ed. New York: McGraw-Hill; 2012: 828.*
What are potential complications of a deep cervical plexus block?	Intravenous injection, spread of the local anesthetic into the epidural or subarachnoid space, and blockade of the phrenic or recurrent laryngeal nerves. *Longnecker DE, Newman MF, Brown DL, Zapol WM. Anesthesiology. 2nd ed. New York: McGraw-Hill; 2012: 828.*
What is the advantage of a cervical plexus block for a patient undergoing carotid endarterectomy?	It allows the patient to be awake during the procedure which provides the most accurate monitoring of neurologic status during carotid cross-clamping. It does not adequately block the carotid sinus reflex, however, and a local infiltration by the surgeon may be necessary to achieve this. *Nagelhout JJ, Plaus KL. Nurse Anesthesia. 5th ed. St. Louis, MO: Elsevier Saunders Company; 2014: 581.*

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